

COURSE REGISTRATION & WITHDRAWAL

Purpose:

This policy outlines the requirements and deadlines for registering for courses and withdrawing from them.

Scope:

This policy applies to all currently enrolled students.

Policy:

Course Registration

- A. Registration must be for a specified number of courses.
- B. Regardless of the number of course credits previously earned, degree candidates must elect a minimum number of three courses required each semester.
- C. A registration PIN is required for the initial schedule each semester, which can be obtained from the student's academic adviser.

Course Cancellation

The University reserves the right to cancel any course for which fewer than eight students are registered or for other cogent reasons.

Courses That May Not Be Elected for Credit

- A. No credit will be given (nor may a second grade be earned) for a course previously passed or for a course with content similar to one previously completed.
 - 1. A list of such cross-listed courses is published in each semester's *Schedule of Classes*.
- B. In addition, courses that have been audited may not be taken subsequently for credit.
- C. Language courses that are below the student's language placement may not be elected for credit unless, in extenuating circumstances, authorized by the language department chair (or program director) and the dean of the student's college.

Auditing

- A. By definition, it is not appropriate to enroll as an auditor for courses involving studio art, dance, sign language, independent study, thesis preparation, or for any course requiring extra time and attention from the instructor. Note that courses that have been audited may not be taken subsequently for credit.

- B. Regularly enrolled, full-time undergraduate students may carry audits in addition to their regular course load without additional charge.
 - 1. For any audit by all other students, the course audit fee is charged.
 - 2. For full-time undergraduates, permission from the course instructor, the student's faculty academic adviser and the student's college academic associate dean is required. Selecting an audit when registering for courses is not allowed without these permissions. The only exception is when a student is required to take a course for audit as part of their major requirements.
- C. The deadline to change a course grade option of audit to a letter grade or a letter grade to audit for full-time undergraduate students is the end of the fourth week of the semester. In either case, permission from the course instructor, the faculty academic adviser, and the college's academic associate dean is required.
 - 1. If a change from audit to a letter grade results in the student being enrolled in more than 4.75 credits for the semester, approval to overload is required.
 - 2. If a change from a letter grade to audit results in the student being enrolled in less than 4.0 credits, approval for an underload is required.
 - a. Students receiving financial aid who become deficient in total credits as the result of changing from a letter grade to an audit are responsible for contacting the financial aid office to discuss their status; they should do so prior to making the change.

Adding & Dropping Courses

Students may add and drop courses, subject to space availability, during the first two weeks of the semester with the appropriate signatures as defined in the academic calendar for each semester.

Course Withdrawal

0.75 credit or Higher Courses

- A. Students may withdraw from a course during the usual two-week drop/add period by filing a completed Drop/Add form with the registrar. If another course is not added, the remaining course load must be no less than the minimum required three course credits and normal progress toward the degree will be considered. Reducing the course load to three course credits requires the approval of the faculty adviser and academic dean.
 - 1. Financial aid packages are not likely to be extended or redefined to cover extra summers or semesters when the student elects a less-than-average course load, thereby requiring additional periods of enrollment. Questions concerning the financial aid ramifications of

"less-than-average course loads" should be pursued directly with the Office of Financial Aid.

- B. After the usual two-week drop/add period, all course withdrawals must be approved by the student's academic dean. In unusual circumstances, dropping a course may be approved through the fourth week of the semester if the student is still carrying three course credits; in two semesters, as exceptions to this four-week limit, dropping a course may be permitted through the 10th week of the semester.
 - 1. The grade of "W" is assigned for all such approved course withdrawals after the first two weeks of the semester.
- C. Exceptions to these deadlines may be approved only if there are serious extenuating circumstances. The assistant/associate academic dean will consider information provided from appropriate professional resources in the determination of whether a student's circumstances are extenuating.
 - 1. Poor performance, anticipation of poor performance, extracurricular obligations, changes in educational plans or interests, or the existence of extra course credits are not considered extenuating circumstances.

0.25 Credit Courses

- A. If a student drops or withdraws from a 0.25 credit course at any point in the semester, they do not receive a grade of W; it is treated as a drop regardless of when it happens during the semester.

0.50 Credit Courses

- B. A 0.50 credit course dropped or withdrawn by a student before the end of the four-week withdrawal period does not receive a grade of W.
- C. If a student withdraws from a 0.50 credit course after the four-week withdrawal period ends, it will be designated with a grade of W; however, the W does not count as one of their two allowed 10-week late withdrawals.